

DOCUMENT 10 · SPHERE MAP AND AMBITION LEVELS

# Sphere map and ambition levels

Where to use AI and with what ambition, in business language and with measurable indicators

Fernando García Varela   Version 0.1 (working draft)   16-09-2026   Draft for review

9

impact spheres

3

ambition levels

60

indicators with a  
formula

2

spheres with their  
own levels

## IN THIS DOCUMENT

|    |                                                   |    |                                                   |
|----|---------------------------------------------------|----|---------------------------------------------------|
| 01 | Purpose and scope                                 | 08 | Sphere × level heat map (T16)                     |
| 02 | The impact map                                    | 09 | Use of the map in the two cycles                  |
| 03 | The three ambition levels                         | 10 | Conversation with the board and first ninety days |
| 04 | Classification rules on the map                   | 11 | Associated tools and templates                    |
| 05 | Profiles of spheres 01 to 07                      | 12 | Related documents                                 |
| 06 | Sphere 08 · Regulation, ethics and accountability | 13 | Version control                                   |
| 07 | Sphere 09 · AI governance                         |    |                                                   |

**Legal notice and disclaimer.** SEVEN-G is a reference methodological framework provided "as is" and for information purposes only. It does not constitute legal, regulatory, financial or professional advice, nor does it guarantee compliance with any law or standard. References to general regulation (such as the EU AI Act, the GDPR, DORA or NIS2), to technical standards and to regulation specific to each sector or jurisdiction may be incomplete, may not apply to a particular case or may become out of date as a result of regulatory changes, interpretations or supervisory positions after their consultation date. **Each organisation that uses SEVEN-G is solely responsible for identifying the regulation that applies to it, verifying that it is current and certifying its own regulatory compliance,** with the appropriate qualified advice. The author accepts no liability for any use made of this content or for any decisions taken on the basis of it. The data, figures, companies and cases in the examples are fictitious or illustrative.

THE ESSENTIALS

Always mandatory

Every initiative is classified in a primary sphere and an ambition level using the rules in section 4, and the board sets the ambition per sphere in C2. The sheets for each sphere and their indicators are consulted when working in that sphere.

Obligation matrix and layered reading (document 94)

## Purpose and scope

This document develops the SEVEN-G **impact map**: nine spheres in which artificial intelligence affects an organisation and three ambition levels at which each of them can be addressed. It establishes:

- What each sphere covers, what questions the board should ask, which examples correspond to each level and which signs indicate that something is not going well.
- **Indicators with a formula** for each sphere, so that the map can be measured and not merely described.
- The **classification rules** for placing an initiative on the map: primary sphere, secondary sphere and ambition level.
- The **specific rule for spheres 08 and 09**, which are assessed on their own levels and must not be mixed with Optimise, Augment and Transform.
- The portfolio **heat map** (tool T16) and its use in the corporate cycle (C1 to C5) and in the lifecycle (phases 1, 2 and 7).

The detailed classification of an initiative's ambition level (five questions and decision rules) is in document 12. Setting the target ambition by sphere is an output of C2 and is documented with document 13.

The indicator codes in this document ( IE01.01 ...) are provisional. Document 41 (Indicator catalogue) consolidates them with the rest of the framework's indicators.

## The impact map

A board does not decide on models or platforms: it decides on risk, opportunity, competitive advantage and accountability. The map makes it possible to talk about AI **without talking about**

**technology** and to check that the company governs it across the organisation, not as a set of isolated technical projects.

## Impact map: nine spheres

From the outside in: where value is created, what enables it, the boundaries and the governance that connects it all



### Where value is created

01 Customer · 02 Product and service · 03 People · 04 Operations

### Enablers

05 Data · 06 Knowledge · 07 Decision.  
This is where the uncomfortable questions arise.

### Boundaries

08 Regulation, ethics and accountability.  
Assessed in terms of compliance, anticipation and ethical leadership.

### Meta-sphere

09 AI governance. Connects the other eight with the formality of finance, risk or compliance.

Source: SEVEN-G

| Type                   | Sphere                   | Motto                                    | What it contributes to the analysis         |
|------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Where value is created | 01 · Customer            | Knowledge, relationship and anticipation | Revenue, retention and experience.          |
|                        | 02 · Product and service | AI inside, on top of or as the product   | Offering, differentiation and new revenue.  |
|                        | 03 · People              | Recipients, subjects and promoters of AI | Work, capabilities, roles and organisation. |

| Type        | Sphere                                     | Motto                                                           | What it contributes to the analysis                                      |
|-------------|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|             | 04 · Operations                            | Processes, value chain and efficiency                           | Cost, time, quality and operational resilience.                          |
| Enablers    | 05 · Data                                  | The material substrate of all AI                                | Availability, quality and legitimate use of data.                        |
|             | 06 · Knowledge                             | Organisational memory and collective intelligence               | Critical knowledge that is accessible and not dependent on a few people. |
|             | 07 · Decision                              | Who decides, with what information and with how much delegation | Allocation of decisions between people and systems.                      |
| Boundaries  | 08 · Regulation, ethics and accountability | Regulation, principles and chain of accountability              | Compliance, anticipation and ethical leadership.                         |
| Meta-sphere | 09 · AI governance                         | The sphere that connects the other eight                        | Structure, balance between speed and control, and supplier ecosystem.    |

Principles for using the map:

- 1. The nine spheres cover the whole organisation.** If an initiative does not fit into any of them, its business objective is most probably unclear.
- 2. The enabling spheres constrain the value spheres.** An ambition to Transform in Customer or in Product without sufficient capability in Data, Knowledge and Decision is a sign of risk, not of boldness.
- 3. Spheres 08 and 09 do not generate value in themselves:** they set the boundaries and the governance system. That is why they are assessed on their own levels (sections 6 and 7).
- 4. The map is read at three points in time:** current situation (C1), target ambition (C2) and the portfolio that delivers it (C3).

## The three ambition levels

Ambition levels **are not a ladder**. It is not mandatory to go through Optimise to reach Transform, nor is Transform better than Optimise. They are three types of bet with different cost, risk, timescale and organisational resistance, which are chosen deliberately.

| Aspect                           | Optimise                                                                         | Augment                                                             | Transform                                                                 |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>What it means</b>             | Doing the same thing faster, more cheaply or with fewer errors.                  | People do what they could not do before.                            | What is offered, how the company competes or how it is organised changes. |
| <b>What changes</b>              | The efficiency of a task or process. What is done and who does it do not change. | The role and capabilities of people. The business does not change.  | The value proposition, the revenue model or the operating model.          |
| <b>Where the value lies</b>      | Mainly in efficiencies (avoided cost).                                           | Combined: cost and performance (productivity, quality, conversion). | Mainly in return and in changes to the operating model.                   |
| <b>Uncertainty</b>               | Low: the baseline is known.                                                      | Medium: it depends on adoption.                                     | High: it depends on the market, the customer or the organisation.         |
| <b>Organisational resistance</b> | Low or localised.                                                                | Medium: it requires a change of habits and role.                    | High: it affects structures, incentives and decision-making power.        |
| <b>Main gate criterion</b>       | Positive annual net value within the horizon set in C2.                          | Actual adoption and performance improvement.                        | Learning milestones, investment limit per stage and market evidence.      |
| <b>Who decides</b>               | Area management, within the portfolio framework.                                 | Management, with visibility for the AI Committee.                   | Explicit decision of the board or senior management.                      |
| <b>Common mistake</b>            | Counting released capacity as savings.                                           | Measuring assigned licences instead of usage and performance.       | Calling an automation with a good narrative a transformation.             |

General rules:

- **Every initiative has a single ambition level**, classified with the five questions in document 12. If an initiative combines components of different levels, it is split or classified according to the component that justifies the investment.

- **Ambition refers to what changes in the business**, not to the technology used. A generative AI agent can be Optimise; a classical statistical model can be Transform.
- **The ambition of a sphere** (in C1 or in C2) is expressed through the levels of the initiatives that make it up; it is not assigned by opinion.

## 04

# Classification rules on the map

## 4.1 Primary sphere and secondary sphere

Each initiative is recorded in the initiative register (T01) with a mandatory **primary sphere** and, at most, one **secondary sphere**.

### # Rule

- 1 The **primary sphere** is the one in which the **main metric of the value hypothesis** is measured. It is not decided by the technology, by the sponsoring area or by the supplier.
- 2 The **secondary sphere** is only recorded if there is a second relevant effect **measurable with an indicator of that sphere** or an explicit organisational change. It is not used to flag generic dependencies.
- 3 Spheres **05 Data, 06 Knowledge and 07 Decision** are primary only when the main outcome is the enabling capability itself (a data catalogue, a knowledge base, a decision system). The fact that an initiative uses data does not place it in sphere 05.
- 4 Sphere **03 People** is primary when the main outcome concerns work, capabilities or the organisation. It should be recorded as secondary in every Augment or Transform initiative that changes roles.
- 5 Spheres **08 and 09** are primary only when the purpose of the initiative is compliance or governance (for example, an AI system to monitor regulatory obligations or to maintain the inventory). They are **never** used to indicate that an initiative carries regulatory risk: that is recorded in the regulatory classification and in the risk register.
- 6 Investment and value are allocated **only to the primary sphere** (measurement rule 5: each euro is attributed to a single use case). The secondary sphere appears on the map as a marker, without amounts.
- 7 If the main metric changes at G2 or G7, the primary sphere is reviewed and the change is recorded as an event.

Common borderline cases (illustrative examples):

| Initiative                                                                                  | Primary                                  | Secondary                                                       | Reason                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Assistant that drafts responses to customer complaints for the customer service team</b> | 04 Operations                            | 01 Customer, only if satisfaction or repeat contact is measured | The main metric is handling time per complaint.                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Product recommender in the digital channel</b>                                           | 01 Customer                              | 02 Product and service, if it modifies the offering             | The main metric is incremental conversion.                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Common data platform for several AI use cases</b>                                        | 05 Data                                  | —                                                               | The outcome is the enabling capability; the value of the use cases that use it is allocated to those use cases.                                                                                |
| <b>Generative assistant built into the office suite for several business units</b>          | 03 People                                | 06 Knowledge, if access to information is measured              | It is a cross-unit initiative: it is recorded once and measured by business unit (document 40 §7.2). It is not an enabling capability of spheres 05 to 07: its outcome falls on people's work. |
| <b>Copilot for risk analysts that enables them to review more complex transactions</b>      | 03 People or 07 Decision                 | The other of the two                                            | Primary according to the metric: analyst performance (03) or decision quality (07).                                                                                                            |
| <b>AI system that monitors regulatory changes and assigns them to owners</b>                | 08 Regulation, ethics and accountability | —                                                               | Its purpose is regulatory anticipation.                                                                                                                                                        |

## 4.2 Rule for spheres 08 and 09

Spheres 08 and 09 **are not assessed with Optimise, Augment and Transform**, because they do not generate value in themselves. They have their own dimensions and grades:

| Sphere                                            | Dimensions                                                         | Grades for each dimension              |
|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| <b>08 · Regulation, ethics and accountability</b> | Compliance · Anticipation · Ethical leadership                     | Absent · Basic · Systematic · Advanced |
| <b>09 · AI governance</b>                         | Structure · Balance between speed and control · Supplier ecosystem | Absent · Basic · Systematic · Advanced |

To avoid mixing them with the three levels, the following rules apply:

| # | Rule                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Mistake it prevents                                                                                              |
|---|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | On the heat map, rows 08 and 09 show <b>grades by dimension</b> , never Optimise, Augment or Transform columns.                                                                                                                                                                                             | Presenting "Transform in Regulation" as if it were a business bet.                                               |
| 2 | The C2 target ambition for 08 and 09 is expressed as a <b>target grade by dimension</b> (document 13).                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Setting "Augment governance" as a target, which is not verifiable.                                               |
| 3 | An initiative whose primary sphere is 08 or 09 <b>has an ambition level</b> (it is classified with the five questions, like all the others), but that level <b>is not used</b> to rate the sphere. Its contribution is also recorded as the <b>dimension it contributes to</b> (for example, Anticipation). | Confusing the type of bet of a tool with the company's grade of governance.                                      |
| 4 | The investment of initiatives whose primary sphere is 08 or 09 is shown in a <b>separate band of the heat map</b> ("governance and compliance enablement") and is <b>excluded</b> from signals 1, 2 and 7 of the transformation index (document 12).                                                        | Investment in governance being read as "efficiency" and lowering the profile, or being used to inflate ambition. |
| 5 | The grades of 08 and 09 <b>are not maturity levels</b> . They serve as evidence for dimensions D6 (Risk, security and compliance) and D1 (Strategy and governance) of document 11, but do not replace them.                                                                                                 | Duplicating or contradicting the maturity diagnosis.                                                             |
| 6 | Spheres 08 and 09 <b>cannot be the secondary sphere</b> of an initiative whose purpose is not compliance or governance.                                                                                                                                                                                     | Using the 08 label as a synonym for "carries regulatory risk".                                                   |

Common definition of the grades:

| Grade             | General criterion                                                                                                     | Minimum evidence                                                      |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Absent</b>     | There is no defined owner or practice, or they exist only on an ad hoc and undocumented basis.                        | —                                                                     |
| <b>Basic</b>      | Practices and owners exist, but they depend on specific people or projects and do not cover the whole scope.          | Partial documents or records.                                         |
| <b>Systematic</b> | Defined, approved process applied to the whole scope, with owners and verifiable evidence.                            | Approved procedure, complete records, calculated indicators.          |
| <b>Advanced</b>   | Systematic, with indicators on target for at least two quarters, continuous improvement and review by the third line. | Internal or external audit report with no open major nonconformities. |

## Profiles of spheres 01 to 07

Each profile has the same structure: what it covers, questions for the board, examples by level, warning signs and indicators. **The examples are generic and illustrative**; they are neither recommendations nor market references. The indicators are calculated over the stated scope (company, unit or initiative) and follow the measurement rules in document 00: every amount has a formula and a status, and "no data" is not zero.

### 5.1 Sphere 01 · Customer

**What it covers.** Customer knowledge, segmentation, acquisition, relationship, service, retention and anticipation of needs, across all channels. **It does not cover** the design of the offering (sphere 02) or the internal efficiency of the customer service back office (sphere 04), unless the main metric relates to the customer.

#### Questions for the board

- If a competitor knows our customers better because it uses AI better, how long will it take us to lose relevance?
- What part of the customer relationship is already mediated by AI systems, and who is accountable for its quality?
- Do we know whether AI improves retention and conversion, or whether it only reduces the cost of serving?
- What information do we give customers when they interact with an AI system?

#### Examples by level (illustrative)

| Level            | Examples                                                                                                                                                                                         | What distinguishes it                                              |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Optimise</b>  | Behaviour-based segmentation instead of static demographic data · Classification and routing of enquiries · Early detection of churn risk for existing campaigns.                                | Customer service is the same; its cost or accuracy improves.       |
| <b>Augment</b>   | Real-time personalisation of the proposition · Conversational assistants that resolve complete enquiries with controlled handover · Sentiment analysis across all channels to anticipate crises. | Sales and customer service teams do what they could not do before. |
| <b>Transform</b> | An AI agent becomes the main point of contact · Discovery of unserved market segments with a dedicated offering · Product co-creation with the customer mediated by generative AI.               | How the company relates to customers, or whom it targets, changes. |

## Warning signs

- The assistant's containment rate is measured, but repeat contact and satisfaction are not.
- There is no control group to attribute retention or conversion to AI.
- Complaints related to automated responses increase and nobody analyses them separately.
- Customers do not know they are interacting with an AI system when regulation requires that they be informed.

## Indicators

| Code    | Indicator                                | Formula                                                                                                                                                            | Source                                |
|---------|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| IE01.01 | AI coverage of the customer relationship | $\text{Interactions handled or assisted by AI} \div \text{total interactions} \times 100$                                                                          | Customer service systems and channels |
| IE01.02 | Effective resolution without handover    | $\text{Interactions resolved by AI with no handover or repeat contact within 7 days} \div \text{interactions handled by AI} \times 100$                            | Customer service systems              |
| IE01.03 | Satisfaction differential                | $\text{Average satisfaction in interactions with AI} - \text{average satisfaction without AI (same scale and period)}$                                             | Satisfaction surveys                  |
| IE01.04 | Incremental retention in monetary terms  | $(\text{Retention rate of the treated group} - \text{rate of the control group}) \times \text{customers treated} \times \text{average annual margin per customer}$ | T12, management control               |
| IE01.05 | Incremental conversion in monetary terms | $(\text{Conversion with AI} - \text{conversion of the control group}) \times \text{opportunities treated} \times \text{average margin per sale}$                   | T12, sales CRM                        |
| IE01.06 | Complaints attributable to AI            | $\text{Complaints whose recorded cause is an AI system} \div \text{interactions with AI} \times 10,000$                                                            | Complaints register                   |

## 5.2 Sphere 02 · Product and service

**What it covers.** AI embedded in the product or service, AI that speeds up its design and launch, and AI that is the product itself. **It does not cover** the commercial relationship with the customer (sphere 01).

### Questions for the board

- Are we using AI to protect the current product or to build the next one? If both strategies compete for the same resources, who decides?
- What part of our revenue comes from products or services that would not exist without AI?
- Do we know the AI cost per unit of service and its effect on margin?
- What accountability do we assume towards customers for the behaviour of the AI included in our product?

## Examples by level (illustrative)

| Level            | Examples                                                                                                                                                                              | What distinguishes it                                                              |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Optimise</b>  | Automated testing and defect detection · Assisted generation of code, design or copy to reduce time to launch · Product tuning based on actual usage.                                 | The product is the same; it is produced or improved at lower cost or in less time. |
| <b>Augment</b>   | Intelligent features within the product (recommendations, predictions, assistants) · Product that adapts to each user's context · Dynamically generated documentation and onboarding. | The product offers users new capabilities without changing the business model.     |
| <b>Transform</b> | Service that exists only because there is a model behind it · Shift from selling a product to selling an ongoing capability · Modular offering of capabilities orchestrated by AI.    | What is sold and how it is charged for changes.                                    |

## Warning signs

- AI features are announced without measuring their actual usage.
- The AI cost per unit of service is unknown or grows faster than the product's revenue.
- There is no product owner accountable to the customer for the behaviour of the AI.
- New product initiatives are assessed with the same payback period as efficiency initiatives and are stopped before market evidence is obtained.

## Indicators

| Code           | Indicator                         | Formula                                                                                                                                        | Source                  |
|----------------|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| <b>IE02.01</b> | AI-enabled revenue                | Revenue from products, services or channels that would not exist without AI ÷ total revenue × 100 (same definition as signal 6 in document 12) | Management control, T12 |
| <b>IE02.02</b> | Use of AI features                | Active users who use AI features in the period ÷ active users of the product × 100                                                             | Product telemetry       |
| <b>IE02.03</b> | Reduction in time to launch       | (Median days from idea to launch in the baseline – current median) ÷ baseline median × 100                                                     | Product management      |
| <b>IE02.04</b> | AI cost per unit of service       | Recurring AI cost allocated to the product ÷ units of service delivered                                                                        | T13, document 42        |
| <b>IE02.05</b> | Margin of the AI-enabled offering | (Revenue from the AI-enabled offering – direct costs, including allocated AI cost) ÷ revenue from the AI-enabled offering × 100                | Management control      |
| <b>IE02.06</b> | Defects contained before launch   | Defects detected in testing ÷ (defects detected in testing + defects detected in production) × 100                                             | Quality management      |

## 5.3 Sphere 03 · People

**What it covers.** The effect of AI on work, capabilities, roles, organisational structure and the relationship with employees. People play three simultaneous roles with regard to AI:

| Role              | What it means                                                                                   | What it requires of the company                                                                                                     |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Recipients</b> | AI changes their tools, processes and productivity expectations, without them having chosen it. | Change management, training and AI literacy; adoption depends on them.                                                              |
| <b>Subjects</b>   | AI can restructure, reassign or eliminate jobs.                                                 | Explicit decision by management and the board, dialogue with employee representatives where appropriate, and responsible treatment. |
| <b>Promoters</b>  | Those who know a process best can identify uses of AI that no outsider would see.               | A channel for proposing initiatives that enter the register and the portfolio.                                                      |

### Questions for the board

- Does AI replace, augment or reorganise people's work? That answer defines the culture, the employer brand and talent retention.
- What happens to released capacity: does it become lower cost, is it reassigned or does it simply disappear?
- Do the people who use or oversee AI have training appropriate to their role?
- What proportion of initiatives originates from employees themselves?

### Examples by level (illustrative)

| Level            | Examples                                                                                                                                                            | What distinguishes it                                              |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Optimise</b>  | Automation of repetitive tasks (reports, data entry, triage) · Accelerated onboarding with knowledge assistants · Training adapted to each employee's level.        | The job is the same; low-value work is eliminated.                 |
| <b>Augment</b>   | Specialised copilot by function · Employees who propose and deploy uses of AI in their area under control · Continuous reskilling so that the role evolves with AI. | People carry out tasks they could not do before; the role changes. |
| <b>Transform</b> | Reorganisation of teams around AI systems · Disappearance of functions and creation of new roles · People who oversee autonomous systems instead of executing.      | The organisational structure and the division of work change.      |

## Warning signs

- Released hours are reported without stating whether they have been realised or reassigned.
- The number of assigned licences is measured, not actual usage.
- Decisions on jobs are taken as a technical consequence of a project, without an explicit management decision.
- There is no adoption plan in Augment or Transform initiatives.
- Turnover in the affected groups rises without anyone analysing it.

## Indicators

| Code    | Indicator                     | Formula                                                                                                                                      | Source             |
|---------|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| IE03.01 | Effective adoption            | $\text{Users with active usage in the period (threshold of days of use set by the company)} \div \text{users with access} \times 100$        | Telemetry, T21     |
| IE03.02 | Realised released capacity    | $\text{Released hours converted into actual lower cost} \div \text{measured released hours} \times 100$                                      | T12, T20           |
| IE03.03 | Reassigned released capacity  | $\text{Hours explicitly reassigned to recorded activities} \div \text{measured released hours} \times 100$                                   | T20                |
| IE03.04 | AI literacy by role           | $\text{People with accredited AI training appropriate to their role} \div \text{people who use, oversee or make decisions on AI} \times 100$ | Training register  |
| IE03.05 | Redesigned roles              | $\text{Jobs with a description updated as a result of AI} \div \text{jobs affected by Augment or Transform initiatives} \times 100$          | People, T20        |
| IE03.06 | Employee-promoted initiatives | $\text{Employee-originated initiatives that pass G1} \div \text{employee-originated initiatives registered} \times 100$                      | T01 (origin field) |

## 5.4 Sphere 04 · Operations

**What it covers.** Internal processes, supply chain, production, maintenance, back office, fraud control and operational risks. **It does not cover** processes whose main metric relates to the customer (sphere 01).

### Questions for the board

- Which processes have a demonstrable return within the horizon set in C2, and which require a complete redesign?
- Do we know which are candidates for immediate automation? If we do not, that is the first piece of work.
- Are we automating tasks or redesigning end-to-end processes?
- What happens if an AI system supporting a critical operation fails or degrades?

## Examples by level (illustrative)

| Level            | Examples                                                                                                                                                                 | What distinguishes it                                                 |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Optimise</b>  | Document processing and reconciliations · Demand forecasting and inventory optimisation · Predictive maintenance · Fraud and anomaly detection.                          | The process is the same; its cost, time or error rate improves.       |
| <b>Augment</b>   | Supply chain that adjusts to market signals · Planning with simulated scenarios · Quality control with computer vision or language processing.                           | Operational teams make decisions with capabilities they did not have. |
| <b>Transform</b> | Processes that run and correct themselves with aggregate oversight · Orchestration of workflows by multi-agent systems · Elimination of entire links in the value chain. | The process design and the operating model change.                    |

## Warning signs

- Declared savings with no actual cost reduction in the income statement.
- Isolated task automations that shift the bottleneck to the next step.
- Critical processes supported by AI without a tested rollback plan.
- Agents that execute operational actions without a defined autonomy level.

## Indicators

| Code           | Indicator                       | Formula                                                                                                                                | Source                    |
|----------------|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| <b>IE04.01</b> | Cycle time reduction            | $(\text{Baseline cycle time} - \text{current cycle time}) \div \text{baseline cycle time} \times 100$                                  | Process systems           |
| <b>IE04.02</b> | Change in unit cost             | $(\text{Total process cost} \div \text{units processed}) - \text{baseline unit cost}$                                                  | Management control        |
| <b>IE04.03</b> | Straight-through processing     | $\text{Transactions completed without manual intervention} \div \text{total transactions} \times 100$                                  | Process systems           |
| <b>IE04.04</b> | Error or rework rate            | $\text{Units with errors or rework} \div \text{units processed} \times 100$ , compared with the baseline                               | Quality management        |
| <b>IE04.05</b> | Processes redesigned end to end | $\text{AI-enabled processes redesigned end to end and verified at G5 or G7} \div \text{AI-enabled processes in production} \times 100$ | T01 (question 2 verified) |
| <b>IE04.06</b> | Validated realised savings      | $\Sigma \text{ efficiencies with validated status and an effect on actual cost in the period (€)}$                                     | T12                       |

## 5.5 Sphere 05 · Data

**What it covers.** Availability, quality, cataloguing, lineage, legal basis and architecture of the data used by AI systems, and data as a product. Document 51 develops its governance.

### Questions for the board

- Do we know what data we have, where it is, who is accountable for its quality and whether we can legally use it for AI?
- How many initiatives are delayed or stopped for lack of data?
- Have we documented where the data used by each system in production to make decisions comes from?
- Is our data an advantage that a competitor cannot replicate?

### Examples by level (illustrative)

| Level            | Examples                                                                                                                                                  | What distinguishes it                                   |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Optimise</b>  | Cleansing, standardisation and deduplication · Cataloguing with AI-generated metadata and automated lineage · Continuous monitoring of quality and drift. | Existing data is managed better and with less effort.   |
| <b>Augment</b>   | Synthetic data where real data is scarce · Enrichment with external sources · Natural-language data queries by any authorised employee.                   | More people can use more data to make decisions.        |
| <b>Transform</b> | Data turned into a product or service · Distributed, domain-governed data architecture · Living representation of operations fed in real time.            | Data changes the business model or the operating model. |

### Warning signs

- Initiatives that reach phase 3 without having confirmed access to the data.
- Personal data used to train or feed systems without a documented legal basis.
- Critical datasets without an identified owner.
- Systems in production without data and model lineage.

### Indicators

| Code           | Indicator                | Formula                                                                                               | Source              |
|----------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| <b>IE05.01</b> | Catalogue coverage       | Datasets used by AI systems in production that are catalogued and have an owner ÷ datasets used × 100 | Data catalogue, T02 |
| <b>IE05.02</b> | Quality of critical data | Critical datasets that meet the defined quality thresholds ÷ critical datasets × 100                  | Quality monitoring  |

| Code    | Indicator                   | Formula                                                                                                                          | Source          |
|---------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| IE05.03 | Documented legal basis      | Datasets with personal data used in AI with a documented legal basis ÷ datasets with personal data used in AI × 100              | Data protection |
| IE05.04 | Documented lineage          | AI systems in production with verified data and model lineage (P16) ÷ AI systems in production × 100                             | T02, P16        |
| IE05.05 | Time to data access         | Median days between an initiative's data request and its availability in the authorised environment                              | T01 (events)    |
| IE05.06 | Initiatives blocked by data | Initiatives stopped with the reason "Insufficient data" or on hold for data ÷ initiatives stopped or on hold in the period × 100 | T01             |

## 5.6 Sphere 06 · Knowledge

**What it covers.** Documented and tacit knowledge, organisational memory, knowledge search and reuse, domain-specialised assistants and organisational learning. Document 51 develops its management.

### Questions for the board

- How much critical knowledge depends on a few people and is not available to the organisation?
- If the people who know the most left tomorrow, what would be lost? AI can narrow that gap, but only if work begins before they leave.
- Are the answers from our knowledge assistants reliable, and who verifies them?
- Do we learn from what we have decided and done, or do we repeat mistakes?

### Examples by level (illustrative)

| Level            | Examples                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | What distinguishes it                                       |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Optimise</b>  | Semantic search over internal documentation · FAQ bases updated with AI · Meeting transcription and summarisation with a record of decisions.                                                                                        | What was already written is found sooner.                   |
| <b>Augment</b>   | Capture of experts' tacit knowledge · Domain knowledge assistants (legal, technical, regulatory, product) · Detection of patterns of success and failure in previous projects.                                                       | People access expert knowledge they did not have before.    |
| <b>Transform</b> | The organisation's knowledge as an active system that proposes and does not merely respond · Proprietary knowledge as a competitive advantage that is hard to replicate · The company retains what it has done, decided and learned. | Knowledge changes how the company competes or is organised. |

## Warning signs

- Knowledge assistants without an assessment of the accuracy of their answers.
- Outdated documentation feeding generative AI systems.
- Critical domains that depend on one or two people without a capture plan.
- Access to confidential information through assistants without permission controls.

## Indicators

| Code    | Indicator                      | Formula                                                                                              | Source                |
|---------|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| IE06.01 | Coverage of critical knowledge | Critical domains with documented and accessible knowledge ÷ critical domains identified × 100        | Knowledge map         |
| IE06.02 | Knowledge concentration        | Critical domains that depend on two people or fewer ÷ critical domains identified × 100              | Knowledge map         |
| IE06.03 | Verified accuracy              | Correct answers in a sample reviewed by experts ÷ answers reviewed × 100                             | Assistant evaluations |
| IE06.04 | Useful resolution              | Queries marked as resolved by the user and confirmed by sampling ÷ total queries × 100               | Assistant telemetry   |
| IE06.05 | Currency of sources            | Documents feeding AI systems reviewed within the set time limit ÷ documents feeding AI systems × 100 | Document management   |
| IE06.06 | Time to autonomy               | Median days until a new joiner reaches autonomy in their role, compared with the baseline            | People                |

## 5.7 Sphere 07 • Decision

**What it covers.** Which decisions AI systems make, recommend or execute, with what information, at what autonomy level (A0 to A3) and with what human oversight and traceability.

### Questions for the board

- What does AI decide on its own, what requires human validation and what is never delegated? If we have not defined this, we are delegating by default.
- Can we reconstruct what the system recommended and what the person decided in each relevant decision?
- Which systems act with A2 or A3 autonomy, and who can stop them?
- Are decisions improving with AI, or are they just being made faster?

## Examples by level (illustrative)

| Level            | Examples                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | What distinguishes it                                           |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Optimise</b>  | Dashboards that prioritise relevant information · Predictive alerts before an indicator deteriorates · Automation of low-risk, high-frequency decisions.                                                                     | The same decisions, with less effort or sooner.                 |
| <b>Augment</b>   | Options with risk and probability analysis from which a person chooses · Scenario simulation · Traceability of what AI recommended and what the person decided.                                                              | Decision-makers have analytical capabilities they did not have. |
| <b>Transform</b> | Autonomous decisions in bounded domains (dynamic pricing, resource allocation) · Coordination of decisions between systems with aggregate oversight · Executives who oversee decision systems instead of deciding each case. | Who decides and how decision-making is organised change.        |

## Warning signs

- Systems that execute actions without an assigned autonomy level or a kill switch.
- A human override rate close to zero for months: it may indicate nominal oversight.
- A very high override rate: the system is not calibrated or is not trusted.
- Decisions with significant effects on people without meaningful human review.

## Indicators

| Code           | Indicator                        | Formula                                                                                                                                      | Source       |
|----------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| <b>IE07.01</b> | Decisions with assigned autonomy | Decision types in which AI is involved with an assigned and documented A0–A3 level ÷ decision types in which AI is involved × 100            | T02, P17     |
| <b>IE07.02</b> | Decision traceability            | Assisted decisions with a record of the recommendation and of the human decision ÷ assisted decisions × 100                                  | System logs  |
| <b>IE07.03</b> | Human override rate              | Recommendations overridden or modified by the person ÷ recommendations issued × 100 (interpreted against a band set by the AI Product Owner) | System logs  |
| <b>IE07.04</b> | Tested kill switch               | A2 or A3 systems with a kill switch tested in the last 12 months ÷ A2 or A3 systems × 100                                                    | T10          |
| <b>IE07.05</b> | Improvement in decision quality  | Average outcome of decisions with AI – average outcome of the control group, converted into money (for example, loss avoided)                | T12          |
| <b>IE07.06</b> | Decision latency                 | Median time from when the information is available until the decision is executed, compared with the baseline                                | Process logs |

# Sphere 08 · Regulation, ethics and accountability

**What it covers.** The regulatory framework applicable to AI, the company's voluntary ethical principles and the chain of accountability when something goes wrong. The detail of obligations is in document 34 and the corporate policy in document 31. This document does not constitute legal advice.

**Reference question for the board:** do we govern proactively or do we wait for the regulator to force us? The cost of the second option is measured in penalties, but above all in reputation and trust.

## 6.1 Dimensions and grades

| Dimension          | What it assesses                                                                                                                                                                       | Basic                                                       | Systematic                                                                                                                                | Advanced                                                                                                |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Compliance         | Classification of systems under the <a href="#">EU AI Act</a> , transparency and oversight obligations, data protection in automated decision-making and profiling, sector regulation. | Classification and assessments for some systems, on demand. | All inventoried systems are classified; the required assessments are carried out before G3; nonconformities are managed with time limits. | Systematic, with indicators on target for two quarters and an audit with no open major nonconformities. |
| Anticipation       | Monitoring of emerging regulation, impact assessments before deployment and preparation for external audits.                                                                           | Regulation is followed informally.                          | Monitoring process with an owner; each relevant change has an impact analysis within the time limit; mock audits.                         | The company adapts its systems before the obligation becomes applicable and documents this.             |
| Ethical leadership | Own principles beyond the legal minimum, an ethics body with real veto power and public transparency about the use of AI.                                                              | Published principles with no enforcement mechanism.         | Principles approved by the board, ethical review of the initiatives that require it and a body with documented veto power.                | Periodic public report on the use of AI and recorded veto or modification decisions.                    |

## 6.2 Questions for the board by dimension

| Dimension    | Questions                                                                                                                                             |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Compliance   | Are all our AI systems classified? Could any of them be a prohibited or high-risk practice without our knowing it? Who signs off that classification? |
| Anticipation | Which obligations will apply to us in the next 24 months, and which systems do they affect? Are we prepared for an external AI audit?                 |

| Dimension          | Questions                                                                                                                                              |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ethical leadership | Do we have our own principles that go beyond the law? Is there anyone with real power to say no to an initiative that is profitable but inappropriate? |

## 6.3 Warning signs

- Systems in production with the regulatory classification "Pending classification" beyond the approved time limit.
- Impact assessments carried out after go-live.
- Ethics committee with no decision recorded in a year.
- Detected unauthorised use of AI that has not been regularised.

## 6.4 Indicators

| Code           | Dimension          | Indicator                              | Formula                                                                                                                                                               |
|----------------|--------------------|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>IE08.01</b> | Compliance         | Classified systems                     | $\text{Inventory systems with a regulatory classification other than "Pending classification"} \div \text{inventoried systems} \times 100$                            |
| <b>IE08.02</b> | Compliance         | Required assessments completed on time | $\text{Required impact assessments completed before G3} \div \text{required impact assessments} \times 100$                                                           |
| <b>IE08.03</b> | Compliance         | Overdue regulatory nonconformities     | $\text{Number of major or critical nonconformities of regulatory origin open beyond their time limit at the end of the period}$                                       |
| <b>IE08.04</b> | Anticipation       | Timely analysis of regulatory changes  | $\text{Relevant regulatory changes with an impact analysis within the set time limit} \div \text{relevant regulatory changes identified} \times 100$                  |
| <b>IE08.05</b> | Anticipation       | Early adaptation                       | $\text{Obligations with a future application date and an approved adaptation plan} \div \text{obligations with an application date in the next 24 months} \times 100$ |
| <b>IE08.06</b> | Anticipation       | Unauthorised use regularised           | $\text{Cases of unauthorised use regularised (authorised, replaced or blocked) on time} \div \text{cases detected} \times 100$                                        |
| <b>IE08.07</b> | Ethical leadership | Ethical review applied                 | $\text{Initiatives that require ethical review and have it recorded before G3} \div \text{initiatives that require it} \times 100$                                    |
| <b>IE08.08</b> | Ethical leadership | Effective veto power                   | $\text{Number of initiatives modified or stopped by decision of the ethics body in the last 12 months (reported together with the number reviewed)}$                  |
| <b>IE08.09</b> | Ethical leadership | Public transparency                    | $\text{Systems with direct exposure to people described in the company's public information} \div \text{systems with direct exposure} \times 100$                     |

## Sphere 09 • AI governance

**What it covers.** The meta-sphere that connects the other eight: ultimate accountability for AI, bodies, portfolio, *gates*, reporting to the board, balance between speed and control, and the relationship with AI suppliers. Document 30 develops the governance model and document 36 third-party management.

**Reference question for the board:** does AI have corporate governance with the same formality as finance, risk or compliance?

### 7.1 Dimensions and grades

| Dimension                                | Questions for the board                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Basic                                              | Systematic                                                                                                                                                     | Advanced                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Structure</b>                         | Who has ultimate accountability for the AI strategy? Is there a framework that connects it with the business strategy? Is there a portfolio prioritised by impact and risk? Does the board receive regular and understandable information? | Designated owner; portfolio as a list of projects. | AI thesis and risk appetite approved; AI Committee operational; initiative register with roles and <i>gates</i> ; quarterly dashboard to the board.            | Systematic, with the register of recommendations up to date and the annual C5 review completed.                             |
| <b>Balance between speed and control</b> | Are we accelerating adoption with risk under control? Are there decision gates in the lifecycle? How do we measure our maturity? Can we stop an initiative that is not working?                                                            | Some controls, applied unevenly.                   | <i>Gates</i> with dual validation in all initiatives; Lite or Enterprise intensity determined; reference time limits measured; stops and retirements recorded. | Decision times within time limits without an increase in nonconformities; annual calibration of time limits and thresholds. |
| <b>Supplier ecosystem</b>                | Do we depend on a single model supplier? Do we assess build, buy or partner for each capability? Do contracts protect our data and intellectual property? Do we understand the cost structure of AI?                                       | Known suppliers, without consistent assessment.    | Supplier register with N1–N3 requirement level; minimum contractual clauses; cost by category and by use case.                                                 | Tested exit strategy for N3 suppliers and concentration within risk appetite.                                               |

### 7.2 Warning signs

- Nobody has stopped or retired an initiative in the last 12 months.
- Initiatives in production without a recorded *gate* or without a current continuity review.
- *Gate* decision time well above the reference time limit, which pushes teams to bypass the process.

- A single supplier accounts for most of the spending on models without an exit strategy.

## 7.3 Indicators

| Code    | Dimension         | Indicator                                | Formula                                                                                                                                                |
|---------|-------------------|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| IE09.01 | Structure         | Register coverage                        | Active AI initiatives and systems registered in T01 and T02 with roles assigned without incompatibilities ÷ known active initiatives and systems × 100 |
| IE09.02 | Structure         | Current continuity                       | Systems in production with a continuity review (R6) within its periodicity ÷ systems in production × 100                                               |
| IE09.03 | Structure         | Board recommendations closed on time     | Recommendations closed with evidence within the time limit ÷ recommendations due in the period × 100                                                   |
| IE09.04 | Speed and control | <i>Gate</i> decision time                | Median days between the request and the <i>gate</i> decision, by intensity, compared with the reference time limit                                     |
| IE09.05 | Speed and control | Time to production                       | Median days between registration and G5, by intensity and by ambition level                                                                            |
| IE09.06 | Speed and control | Ability to stop                          | Initiatives stopped or retired with a coded reason in 12 months ÷ initiatives with a <i>gate</i> decision in 12 months × 100                           |
| IE09.07 | Ecosystem         | Concentration in the main model supplier | Spending on the main model supplier ÷ total spending on models × 100                                                                                   |
| IE09.08 | Ecosystem         | Exit strategy                            | N3 suppliers with a documented and tested exit strategy ÷ N3 suppliers × 100                                                                           |
| IE09.09 | Ecosystem         | Allocated AI cost                        | AI cost allocated to use cases through analytical allocation ÷ total AI cost × 100                                                                     |

## 08

# Sphere × level heat map (T16)

The heat map is the portfolio view over the impact map. It is generated from the initiative register (T01) and shown in the board dashboard (T17).

## 8.1 Construction

| Element                     | Definition                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Rows</b>                 | Spheres 01 to 07. Below, in a separate block, spheres 08 and 09 with their dimensions, and the "governance and compliance enablement" band with the investment of initiatives whose primary sphere is 08 or 09.                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Columns</b>              | Optimise · Augment · Transform.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Scope</b>                | Active initiatives (from G0 passed until retirement) and those stopped or retired in the last 12 months, which are shown separately.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Level used</b>           | Actual ambition if it exists; otherwise, confirmed; otherwise, proposed, marked as such.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Content of each cell</b> | Number of initiatives (total and in production) · Investment and annual recurring cost · Validated annual net value · C2 target ambition for the sphere.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Colour</b>               | Share of the cell's investment and recurring cost in the total for spheres 01 to 07: <b>No activity</b> (0 %) · <b>Low</b> (less than 5 %) · <b>Medium</b> (5 % to 15 %) · <b>High</b> (more than 15 %). Initial thresholds, to be calibrated in C5.                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Markers</b>              | <b>Gap:</b> in the cell of the level that matches the sphere's target ambition there is no initiative that has passed G2. · <b>Outside the thesis:</b> investment in a sphere declared non-priority in C2 above 5 % of the total. · <b>No evidence:</b> initiatives with more than 12 months in production and no validated value. · <b>Secondary:</b> number of initiatives that have the sphere as secondary (without amounts). |

In rows 08 and 09 each dimension shows its **current grade** and its **target grade** (Absent, Basic, Systematic or Advanced), calculated with the indicators in sections 6.4 and 7.3 and validated by the AI Office.

## 8.2 Illustrative example

*Illustrative data for a fictitious company. Amounts in millions of euros (investment and annual recurring cost for the period).*

| Sphere                          | C2 target | Optimise                      | Augment                      | Transform         |
|---------------------------------|-----------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>01 · Customer</b>            | Augment   | 3 initiatives · 0.45 · Medium | 1 initiative · 0.30 · Medium | —                 |
| <b>02 · Product and service</b> | Transform | 1 · 0.10 · Low                | —                            | 1 · 0.30 · Medium |
| <b>03 · People</b>              | Augment   | 2 · 0.40 · Medium             | 1 · 0.40 · Medium            | —                 |
| <b>04 · Operations</b>          | Optimise  | 6 · 1.60 · <b>High</b>        | —                            | —                 |

| Sphere                      | C2 target | Optimise                                         | Augment | Transform |
|-----------------------------|-----------|--------------------------------------------------|---------|-----------|
| 05 · Data                   | Augment   | 1 · 0.35 · Medium                                | Gap     | —         |
| 06 · Knowledge              | Augment   | 1 · 0.10 · Low                                   | Gap     | —         |
| 07 · Decision               | Optimise  | Gap                                              | —       | —         |
| Enablement band (08 and 09) | —         | 2 initiatives · 0.25 (outside the total of 4.00) | —       | —         |

| Sphere | Dimension                                      | Current grade               | Target grade                    |
|--------|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------------|
| 08     | Compliance · Anticipation · Ethical leadership | Systematic · Basic · Basic  | Systematic · Systematic · Basic |
| 09     | Structure · Speed and control · Ecosystem      | Systematic · Basic · Absent | Systematic · Systematic · Basic |

Reading for the board: 75 % of the investment (3.00 of 4.00) is in Optimise and 40 % in Operations; the Transform bet in Product exists but is a single one; Data and Knowledge have an Augment target with no initiative delivering it, which weakens the value spheres; Decision has no activity; and the supplier ecosystem is not governed. The same example is used to calculate the transformation index in document 12.

## 09

# Use of the map in the two cycles

## 9.1 Corporate cycle

| Stage             | Use of the map                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Output                                                     | Document |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| C1 ·<br>Diagnosis | Classify existing initiatives and systems by sphere and level; calculate the available indicators; assign grades to 08 and 09; build the current heat map. For each sphere, the <b>level achieved</b> (highest level with at least one initiative in production and measured value) and the <b>level in the portfolio</b> (highest level with any initiative that has passed G2) are recorded. | Current sphere map with explicit indicators and "no data". | 11, 12   |
| C2 ·<br>Direction | Set the priority and target ambition for each sphere 01–07, and the target grade by dimension for 08 and 09, with one main indicator per sphere chosen from those in this document.                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Ambition by sphere approved by the board.                  | 13       |

| Stage                 | Use of the map                                                                                                                                                                                         | Output                                                      | Document |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>C3 · Portfolio</b> | Compare the heat map with the target ambition; prioritise initiatives that close gaps; limit investment outside the thesis; check that the enabling spheres support the ambition of the value spheres. | Prioritised portfolio with sphere and level per initiative. | 14       |
| <b>C4 · Oversight</b> | Quarterly heat map in the board dashboard with gap, outside-the-thesis and no-evidence markers; evolution of the main indicators.                                                                      | Board alerts and recommendations.                           | 60, 62   |
| <b>C5 · Review</b>    | Compare the map with the previous year's and with the target ambition; recalibrate colour thresholds and markers; review the chosen indicators.                                                        | Proposed adjustment of ambition by sphere.                  | 12, 13   |

## 9.2 Initiative lifecycle

| Moment         | What is done                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Who                                                             | Evidence |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Phase 0</b> | The expected sphere is stated in the initiative charter, to check alignment with the thesis.                                                                                                                          | AI Product Owner                                                | P01      |
| <b>Phase 1</b> | The <b>primary sphere, secondary sphere and ambition level</b> are proposed using the rules in section 4 and the five questions in document 12. It is checked whether the sphere is a priority in C2.                 | AI Product Owner; reviewed by the AI Office                     | P07, P06 |
| <b>Phase 2</b> | The primary sphere is confirmed with the main metric of the hypothesis and the ambition level is confirmed. At least one indicator of the primary sphere is chosen as the hypothesis metric or as a secondary metric. | Verified by the AI Office (Lite) or the AI Auditor (Enterprise) | P07, P08 |
| <b>Phase 7</b> | The <b>actual ambition</b> is recorded with the evidence, and the sphere is reviewed if the main metric has changed.                                                                                                  | AI Product Owner; verified by the AI Office or the AI Auditor   | P07, P30 |

An initiative in a sphere that is not a priority according to C2 **may** continue, but the sponsor must justify it at G0 and the AI Committee must be informed of it in C3.

## 10

# Conversation with the board and first ninety days

The impact map is the basis for the first conversation with a board. The full script, with questions, materials and response format, is in document 61. In summary, a sixty-minute session is organised as follows:

| Block                                          | Content                                                                                                      | Minutes |
|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| <b>1 • Strategic framing</b>                   | What business we are in and how AI changes its rules. Presentation of the nine spheres and the three levels. | 10      |
| <b>2 • Spheres where value is created</b>      | Customer, Product and service, People and Operations, with one example per level.                            | 12      |
| <b>3 • Enabling spheres</b>                    | Data, Knowledge and Decision: diagnosis of actual capability.                                                | 10      |
| <b>4 • Regulation</b>                          | <a href="#">EU AI Act</a> , data protection and sector regulation.                                           | 10      |
| <b>5 • Position on people</b>                  | Replace, augment or reorganise work with AI? The board is asked to take a position.                          | 8       |
| <b>6 • AI governance and first ninety days</b> | What governance structure the company needs and how to get started.                                          | 10      |

The **first ninety days** concentrate C1 to C3 (document 01, section 5.3). The detailed plan is in document 90:

| Period         | Objective               | Use of the map                                                                     |
|----------------|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Month 1</b> | Diagnosis               | Current sphere map, grades for 08 and 09 and transformation index profile.         |
| <b>Month 2</b> | Risks and opportunities | Main risks and opportunities by sphere, with owner, economic impact and timescale. |
| <b>Month 3</b> | Governance structure    | Ambition by sphere, main indicators and reporting cadence approved.                |

## 11

# Associated tools and templates

| Code       | Name                | Use in this document                                                                                                          |
|------------|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>T01</b> | Initiative register | Primary and secondary sphere fields, proposed, confirmed and actual ambition level, and contribution dimension for 08 and 09. |
| <b>T02</b> | AI system inventory | Basis for the data, decision, compliance and governance indicators.                                                           |
| <b>T05</b> | Ambition classifier | Five questions from document 12, integrated with sphere selection.                                                            |

| Code       | Name                                      | Use in this document                                                           |
|------------|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>T12</b> | Value realisation tracking                | Indicator amounts converted into money.                                        |
| <b>T14</b> | Transformation index calculator           | Uses the enablement band to exclude spheres 08 and 09 from signals 1, 2 and 7. |
| <b>T16</b> | Portfolio sphere map                      | Heat map in section 8.                                                         |
| <b>T17</b> | Board AI dashboard                        | Shows the heat map and the main indicators by sphere.                          |
| <b>P06</b> | Opportunity portfolio and screening notes | Sphere proposed in phase 1.                                                    |
| <b>P07</b> | Sphere and ambition classification        | Evidence for phases 1, 2 and 7.                                                |
| <b>P31</b> | Use case profile                          | Understandable description with its sphere and level.                          |

## 12

# Related documents

| Document                                                             | Relationship                                                             |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>00 · What SEVEN-G is and how it helps companies</b>               | Presentation of the impact map (section 4.1).                            |
| <b>01 · Foundational methodology</b>                                 | Component A, corporate cycle and <i>gate</i> criteria by ambition level. |
| <b>03 · Tools and initiative register</b>                            | Controlled taxonomy of spheres and levels; tools T05 and T16.            |
| <b>11 · Maturity model</b>                                           | Spheres 08 and 09 provide evidence for D6 and D1.                        |
| <b>12 · Transformation index</b>                                     | Initiative ambition classification and company signals.                  |
| <b>13 · AI thesis, ambition and risk appetite</b>                    | Target ambition by sphere and target grades for 08 and 09.               |
| <b>14 · Portfolio management</b>                                     | Use of the heat map to prioritise and balance.                           |
| <b>30 · Governance model and 36 · AI third parties and suppliers</b> | Development of sphere 09.                                                |
| <b>31 · Corporate policy and 34 · Regulatory mapping</b>             | Development of sphere 08.                                                |

| Document                                                               | Relationship                                                                                                                           |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>41 · Indicator catalogue</b>                                        | Consolidation of indicators IE01.01 to IE09.09.                                                                                        |
| <b>50 · People and organisation</b> and <b>51 · Data and knowledge</b> | Development of spheres 03, 05 and 06.                                                                                                  |
| <b>61 · Board conversation guide</b>                                   | Full sixty-minute script.                                                                                                              |
| <b>90 · Implementation guide</b>                                       | Detailed plan for the first ninety days.                                                                                               |
| <b>SPHERES · SPHERES Library</b>                                       | Supporting methodology that explains the spheres, the ambition levels and the conversation with the board in detail and with examples. |

## 13

# Version control

| Version    | Date       | Changes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|------------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>0.1</b> | 16-09-2026 | First version. Integrates the previous sphere framework into SEVEN-G: profiles of the nine spheres with questions, examples by level, warning signs and indicators with a formula; primary and secondary sphere rules; rule preventing spheres 08 and 09 from being mixed, with their own grades; heat map (T16) and its use in C1–C5 and in phases 1, 2 and 7. |

# External sources cited

Links to the official or primary source, checked before publication. Always verify the version in force on the date of use.

**Regulation (EU) 2024/1689 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 13 June 2024 laying down harmonised rules on artificial intelligence (Artificial Intelligence Act)** · <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2024/1689/oj/eng> · Parlamento Europeo y Consejo de la UE · 13-06-2024